

JAPAN & KOREA



Fish food

The traditional Japanese diet of fish is very healthy. Many Japanese people live to be very old—in 2010, more than a quarter of the population was over 65 years old.



Children on parade

The Seven-Five-Three Festival in Japan is named after the ages of the children who take part. Every year on November 15, girls and boys are dressed up in traditional costumes and taken to a Shinto shrine. It is a very sociable occasion.



Watch your head

These pupils are not hiding from their teacher! They are practicing what to do if there is an earthquake. Earthquakes do not happen often in Japan, but they could happen any time. In the past, they have caused terrible damage.

Japan is famous for its electronic gadgets and machines. In the last 50 years, Japan has become one of the world's richest countries, and many Japanese people enjoy a high standard of living. Its neighbor, Korea, is split into two separate countries. North Korea has cut off its links with the South and is one of the world's most secretive societies. South Korea is a successful industrial country, like Japan, and trades with the rest of the world.

Dinnertime

The evening meal is an important time for busy Japanese families to get together and relax. Parents often get home late from work, and children have lots of homework to do in the evenings.

Rice is cooked until it is sticky, so it is easy to eat with pointed chopsticks.

An electric rice cooker sits close to the table.



Japanese tea is drunk without milk, and is called green tea.